Damena Jackson

Full Stack / Front End Web Developer
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Summary

Full Stack JavaScript Developer specializing in building responsive, user-friendly single-page applications using React.js, JavaScript ES6+, TypeScript, React Hooks, and Context API for state management. Experienced in developing reusable UI components, integrating REST APIs, optimizing frontend performance, and implementing responsive layouts with Material UI and Tailwind CSS. Proficient in Node.js, Express, and PostgreSQL for full-stack development.

Experience

Full Stack Software Engineer | Digital Aid Seattle Dec 2025 – Present

- Shipped features for an Azure-hosted reporting application used by 10+ nonprofit staff to manage data on 60,000+ clients, working in Scrum with 2 engineers and 2 project managers.
- Optimized slow report exports with SQL queries, database indexing, and server-side filtering, cutting export times from hours to minutes, eliminating recurring report errors, and handling concurrent exports reliably.
- Built a reporting system with 50+ configurable filters (e.g., age ranges, first/last name search), custom report generation, real-time data syncing, and audit logging of user actions, none of which the previous system supported.
- Implemented backend PDF, CSV, and Excel exporting options using Python libraries, speeding up export time and enabling flexible data export formats for nonprofit staff reporting needs.
- Developed responsive frontend features using React.js, React Hooks (useState, useEffect, useContext, useMemo), and TypeScript, building reusable UI components with Material UI for consistent design across the application.
- Managed application state using Context API and TanStack Query, integrated REST APIs with Fetch API, and implemented React Router for client-side routing in the single-page application.

Lead Teacher | Saint Frances of Rome | Cicero, IL Aug 2023 – Aug 2025

- Led a classroom of 20 children ages 3–5, planning weekly lessons and individualized activities to support each child's developmental growth.
- Communicated with parents and staff on student progress and adapted plans to individual needs.

Independent Projects

Cosmetic Tracker | *JavaScript, TypeScript, TanStack Query, React, Vite, MUI, PostgreSQL, Prisma, Node.js, Express, Passport, JWT, OAuth 2.0* Jun 2026 – Aug 2026

Built a responsive single-page application using React.js, React Hooks, and Material UI with user authentication, reusable UI components, and Context API for state management. Integrated REST APIs using Fetch API, implemented React Router for client-side routing, and optimized performance with lazy loading and code splitting.

Social Media Platform | *JavaScript, React, Vite, PostgreSQL, Prisma, Node.js, Express, Passport, CSS* Feb 2026 – Apr 2026

Developed a responsive social media SPA using React.js, JavaScript ES6+, and CSS3 with reusable components, React Router for navigation, and REST API integration. Implemented authentication with JWT, built responsive layouts using Flexbox and CSS Grid, and managed application state with Context API.

Education

The Odin Project – Curriculum | Full Stack JavaScript Mar 2025 – Dec 2025

Project-based curriculum in JavaScript, React, Node.js, Express, PostgreSQL, and test-driven development.

Northern Illinois University | DeKalb, IL | B.S. Psychology and Child Development Aug 2018 – May 2022

Skills

React & Frontend: React.js, JavaScript ES6+, TypeScript, HTML5, CSS3, React Hooks, Context API, React Router, Single-Page Applications, Responsive Web Design, WCAG

UI Frameworks & Styling: Material UI (MUI), Tailwind CSS, CSS Grid, Flexbox, Media Queries

API & State Management: REST APIs, Fetch API, JSON, TanStack Query, Context API, JWT, OAuth 2.0

Backend & Database: Node.js, Express, PostgreSQL, Prisma (ORM), Azure Database

Testing & Tools: Jest, Test-Driven Development, Vite, npm, Webpack, Git, GitHub, VS Code, Chrome DevTools, ESLint, Prettier, Agile, Scrum